

Which metric, and what it hides

Report MASE alongside a percentage metric. The percentage is what a planner feels; the MASE is what makes it comparable.

metric	formula	strength	fails when
MAE	mean $ y - \hat{y} $	same units, robust	not comparable across series of different scale
RMSE	$\sqrt{\text{mean } (y - \hat{y})^2}$	penalises large misses	dominated by outliers; scale-bound
MAPE	mean $ y - \hat{y} / y $	scale-free, intuitive	explodes near zero; over-forecasts capped at 100%
sMAPE	symmetric percentage	bounded	still unstable near zero; awkward to interpret
MASE	MAE / MAE of seasonal-naive	scale-free, symmetric, defined at zero	needs a sensible baseline period m
Pinball	the quantile loss, averaged	a PROPER score — rewards honest calibration	not useful for a probabilistic forecast
Coverage	$P(y \text{ inside the interval})$	the number operations feels	marginal coverage hides conditional holes

MASE < 1 beats the free seasonal-naive baseline · MASE = 1 ties it · MASE > 1 means you should have shipped the baseline.